Chinese were being allowed to call the shots. Static Indian posts, mostly held by a platoon or a section, were taken out one by one by the Chinese. By 23 October, Indian troops at Srijap on the northern bank of the Pangong Tso were under fire, and the entire sector extending from Chushul to Demchok was being threatened.

In the Eastern Sector, apart from Kameng, the threat of the Siliguri chicken neck being cut off by a thrust down the Chumbi Valley either through Sikkim or Bhutan had to be considered. In addition, there was also a possibility of Chinese attacks in the central part of NEFA where a string of Assam Rifles posts existed. To the extreme east at the tri-junction of China, India and Burma, the Chinese had already launched an attack on Kibithu on 20 October, pushing the Indians back towards Walong. There was now a real danger of an encircling move that would threaten Hayuliang, Lohitpur and Tezu.

The Pakistan factor could not be completely ruled out either. Insurgency in Nagaland had more or less tied down 23 Division plus a number of Assam Rifles troops. General Thapar and Army HQ now had to find the troops to support Harbaksh Singh and Anant Pathania on Se-la. At the commencement of hostilities, 62 Brigade had moved from Ramgarh but had got splintered while still on the move. 65 Brigade (newly raised at Secunderabad; it had only two battalions) had already been moved north.

Bogey Sen was unwilling to move any troops out of Nagaland. The army chief, however, decided to pull out most of 23 Division which was considered to be a reserve formation against the Chinese. Thapar was also willing to gamble that the Western Sector against Pakistan would remain dormant. Accordingly, one brigade of 17 Division was ordered to move post-haste from Punjab to the Siliguri area to be followed by the rest of the division. One brigade from Nagaland was asked to deploy around the Daranga area (bordering southeast Bhutan), while another was moved as a corps reserve to Tezpur. 11 Brigade, then stationed around Imphal, was asked to move immediately to Walong where it would relieve 5 Brigade which in turn would look after central NEFA. A new division was to be set up, headquartered in the Tinsukia area to look after central and eastern NEFA. Finally, Thapar also decided to move armour into the area—he decided to allocate a light regiment equipped with the French AMX-13 tanks to IV Corps while another regiment with the relatively heavier Sherman tanks was to be stationed at Siliguri.